MODULE 7

Everyone Has a Story

"He who is not courageous enough to take risks will accomplish nothing in life."

— MUHAMMAD ALI

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How do our experiences shape our lives?

MAIN STORIES

1	**I Am Helen Keller**	· Brad Meltzer	BIOGRAPHY
2	**How to Make a Timeline**	· Boyd N. Gillin	PROCEDURAL
3	**The Stories He Tells: Joseph Bruchac**	· James Bruchac	BIOGRAPHY
4	**Drum Dream Girl**	· Margarita Engle	POETRY

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NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 7 · Everyone Has a Story · Grade 2 · 27 Items

CCSS L.2.4 · L.2.5 · L.2.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.2.6

account

An **account** is —

- ○ **A.** the money you keep in a bank.
- ○ **B.** a question you ask about an event.
- ○ **C.** a guess about what will happen next.
- ○ **D.** a report of something that happened.

Q2 L.2.6

achieve

When you **achieve** something, you —

- ○ **A.** give up on it.
- ○ **B.** try it but fail.
- ○ **C.** get it after a lot of hard work.
- ○ **D.** get it by luck, with no effort.

Q3 L.2.6

hurdle

A **hurdle** is —

- ○ **A.** a prize you win at the end.
- ○ **B.** a problem that could stop you from doing something.
- ○ **C.** an easy path with nothing in the way.
- ○ **D.** a helper who clears the way for you.

POWER WORDS · I AM HELEN KELLER

Q4 L.2.4

deal

"People didn't know how to **deal** with someone like me." Here, **deal** means —

- ○ **A.** handle or work with.
- ○ **B.** give out cards in a game.
- ○ **C.** buy and sell.
- ○ **D.** a very good price.

Q5 L.2.5 TRAP

figured

"I had **figured** out small ways to communicate." Here, **figured** means —

- ○ **A.** drew a picture of.
- ○ **B.** shaped a body (a "figure").
- ○ **C.** worked out — understood through thinking.
- ○ **D.** counted to ten.

Q6 L.2.4

communicate

To **communicate** is to —

- ○ **A.** hide your feelings forever.
- ○ **B.** share thoughts and feelings with another person.
- ○ **C.** live alone with no friends.
- ○ **D.** keep quiet and say nothing to anyone.

POWER WORDS · I AM HELEN KELLER (CONTINUED)

Q7 L.2.4

motioned

"To say FATHER, I **motioned** putting on glasses." Here, **motioned** means —

- ○ **A.** said the word out loud.
- ○ **B.** wrote the word on paper.
- ○ **C.** drew a picture of it.
- ○ **D.** showed something by moving the body — a sign or gesture.

Q8 L.2.4

approached

"Someone **approached** — I could feel footsteps." To **approach** is to —

- A. come closer to someone or something.
- B. walk far away.
- C. sit down and stay still.
- D. turn around and go back.

Q9 L.2.5 TRAP

series

Helen learned a **series** of new words. Here, a **series** is —

- A. one thing all by itself.
- B. a TV show only.
- C. a single moment.
- D. a set of things that come one after another in order.

Q10 L.2.4

selfless

"Miss Sullivan was patient and **selfless**." **Selfless** means —

- A. only thinking about yourself.
- B. wanting all the credit for yourself.
- C. thinking about other people more than yourself.
- D. too proud to help anyone.

Q11 L.2.4

potential

Miss Sullivan saw Helen's **potential**. **Potential** is —

- A. the past — what already happened.
- B. what a person could become or do in the future.
- C. what a person can already do right now.
- D. a kind of pot (sounds a little like the word).

Q12 L.2.4

timeline

A **timeline** is —

- A. a line that shows events in the order they happened.
- B. a list of events all mixed up, in no order.
- C. a clock that tells you the time of day.
- D. a map that shows where places are.

Q13 L.2.5 TRAP

statements

"Read the **statements** Tramayne wrote." A **statement** is —

- A. a question that asks for an answer.
- B. a building where you wait for a train (a "station").
- C. an order that tells someone what to do.
- D. a sentence that tells a fact about something.

Q14 L.2.4

arrange

"**Arrange** all of your notecards in order." To **arrange** is to —

- A. mix them up so there is no order.
- B. put things in a planned order.
- C. count how many there are.
- D. hide them out of sight.

Q15 L.2.5 TRAP

current

"Put the most **current** one on the right." Here, **current** means —

- A. happening now — the most recent.
- B. water that flows in a river.
- C. a small dried fruit.
- D. electricity moving in a wire.

POWER WORDS · THE STORIES HE TELLS

Q16 L.2.4

ashamed

Joseph used to feel **ashamed** of his heritage. **Ashamed** means —

- **A.** proud and glad about who you are.
- **B.** surprised by something new.
- **C.** feeling bad or embarrassed about who you are.
- **D.** scared of the dark.

POWER WORDS · THE STORIES HE TELLS (CONTINUED)

Q17 L.2.4

elders

Joseph learned old stories from the **elders**. **Elders** are —

- **A.** older people in a family or community.
- **B.** baby brothers and sisters.
- **C.** young children the same age as you.
- **D.** strangers you have never met.

Q18 L.2.4

overflowing

Joseph's heart was **overflowing** with pride. **Overflowing** means —

- **A.** empty, with nothing inside.
- **B.** only half full.
- **C.** filled right up to the very top, but not spilling.
- **D.** so full that it spills over.

Q19 L.2.4

pride

Joseph felt **pride** in his heritage. **Pride** is —

- **A.** a feeling of shame about who you are.
- **B.** a happy, glad feeling about who you are or what you have done.
- **C.** a feeling of being scared.
- **D.** a feeling of being bored.

POWER WORDS · DRUM DREAM GIRL

Q20 L.2.5 TRAP

secret

The girl kept her drum dream a **secret**. A **secret** is —

- ○ **A.** a kind of small drum.
- ○ **B.** news that everyone already knows.
- ○ **C.** a story you tell out loud to the whole class.
- ○ **D.** something you keep hidden — only you (or a few) know it.

Q21 L.2.4

whir

"She heard the **whir** of parrot wings." A **whir** is —

- ○ **A.** a low, soft, fast humming sound.
- ○ **B.** a sharp, loud bang.
- ○ **C.** a slow, quiet whisper.
- ○ **D.** a long, high squeak.

POWER WORDS · DRUM DREAM GIRL (CONTINUED)

Q22 L.2.4

reminding

Her father kept **reminding** her of the rule. **Reminding** someone means —

- ○ **A.** helping them forget something.
- ○ **B.** teaching them something brand new.
- ○ **C.** helping them remember something.
- ○ **D.** keeping a secret from them.

Q23 L.2.5 TRAP

dared

She **dared** to dream of drumming. Here, **dared** means —

- ○ **A.** hid under a blanket.
- ○ **B.** was brave enough to do something hard or risky.
- ○ **C.** was too afraid to try.
- ○ **D.** a sharp tool used to dig (a "dart").

Q24 L.2.4

alone

"Dreaming and drumming **alone**." **Alone** means —

- A. together with a friend.
- B. with a big crowd.
- C. in a group with your whole family.
- D. by yourself, with no one else.

Q25 L.2.4

deserved

The teacher said her drumming **deserved** to be heard. **Deserved** means —

- A. earned the right to something good.
- B. got something without earning it at all.
- C. a dessert at the end of dinner (sounds alike).
- D. was not good enough to be chosen.

Q26 L.2.5 TRAP

starlit

"A concert at the **starlit** café." **Starlit** means —

- A. lit up by bright electric lamps.
- B. filled with stars on a sign.
- C. lit up by stars — under a sky full of stars.
- D. dark, with no light at all.

Q27 L.2.5 TRAP

allowed

"In Cuba, only boys were **allowed** to play drums." Here, **allowed** means —

- A. spoken in a loud voice ("aloud").
- B. given permission to do something.
- C. told they must NOT do it.
- D. forced to do it whether they wanted to or not.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 7 · Everyone Has a Story · Grade 2

CCSS RL.2.1 – RL.2.6 / RI.2.1 – RI.2.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each story to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the best answer.

Story 1 · I Am Helen Keller

BIOGRAPHY · BRAD MELTZER · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.2.1

What happened to Helen Keller when she was 19 months old?

- ○ **A.** She became blind and deaf — she could not see or hear.
- ○ **B.** She moved to a new country.
- ○ **C.** She started school.
- ○ **D.** She lost her favorite dog.

Q2 RI.2.3

How did Helen first try to "say" the word FATHER?

- ○ **A.** She shouted very loudly.
- ○ **B.** She made the gesture of putting on glasses — a sign she had figured out.
- ○ **C.** She wrote it in a letter.
- ○ **D.** She tapped on the window.

Q3 RI.2.3

Who came to help Helen learn to communicate?

- ○ **A.** Her dog, Belle.
- ○ **B.** Her father alone.
- ○ **C.** Miss Anne Sullivan, her teacher.
- ○ **D.** A doctor from the city.

Q4 RI.2.6

Why MOST LIKELY did Brad Meltzer write "I Am Helen Keller"?

- **A.** To teach readers how to take care of a dog like Belle.
- **B.** To explain the best way to put on a pair of glasses.
- **C.** To list every city that Helen Keller ever visited.
- **D.** To show how Helen faced great hurdles and to inspire readers.

Q5 RI.2.3

Before Miss Sullivan came, why was it hard for people to "deal with" Helen?

- **A.** Helen could not see or hear, so they did not know how to talk with her.
- **B.** Helen was angry every day.
- **C.** Helen lived in another country.
- **D.** Helen was too tall.

Q6 RI.2.5

"I Am Helen Keller" is a biography. What makes it a biography?

- **A.** It tells the true life story of a real person.
- **B.** It is a made-up story with talking animals.
- **C.** It uses only pictures, no words.
- **D.** It is a list of recipes.

Q7 RI.2.3

What did Miss Sullivan see in Helen that others did not?

- **A.** A wish to play card games.
- **B.** A love of cooking.
- **C.** A way to fly a kite.
- **D.** Helen's potential — what she could become.

Q8 RI.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "I Am Helen Keller"?

- **A.** Helen became famous only because she was born different from everyone else.
- **B.** Miss Sullivan did all of the hard work, and Helen only had to sit and listen.
- **C.** A patient teacher and Helen's own hard work helped her find a way to communicate.
- **D.** A child who cannot see or hear can never truly learn or be taught anything.

Story 2 · How to Make a Timeline

PROCEDURAL TEXT · BOYD N. GILLIN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.2.5

"How to Make a Timeline" is procedural text. What does that mean?

- ○ **A.** It teaches you how to DO something step by step.
- ○ **B.** It is a long poem about time.
- ○ **C.** It is a biography of a real person.
- ○ **D.** It is a song with no words.

Q10 RI.2.8

The text shows clock symbols next to the biography and next to the timeline. How do these symbols support the author's point?

- ○ **A.** They prove that Tramayne is older than John Hancock.
- ○ **B.** They show that a timeline takes less time to read than a full biography.
- ○ **C.** They tell readers the exact time that each event happened.
- ○ **D.** They show that a clock belongs on top of every timeline.

Q11 RI.2.3

Tramayne wrote **statements** about his life. Why does the text show his statements?

- ○ **A.** To prove that Tramayne is the best writer in his class.
- ○ **B.** To show readers a model — the kind of sentence to write on a timeline.
- ○ **C.** To tell the whole life story of Tramayne in order.
- ○ **D.** To let readers copy Tramayne's events as their own.

Q12 RI.2.3

According to the text, after you write your statements, what should you do FIRST?

- ○ **A.** Draw a long line on paper and add dates.
- ○ **B.** Read the most current statement out loud first.
- ○ **C.** Pick only the most important statement to keep.
- ○ **D.** Arrange the notecards in the order the events happened.

Q13 RI.2.5

How is "How to Make a Timeline" MOSTLY organized?

- **A.** By steps in order — from the first thing to do to the last.
- **B.** By Tramayne's life story told from beginning to end.
- **C.** By a list comparing two different kinds of timelines.
- **D.** By a problem and the way Tramayne solved it.

Q14 RI.2.6

Why MOST LIKELY did Boyd N. Gillin write this text?

- **A.** To tell the true life story of Tramayne in careful detail.
- **B.** To explain why a timeline is always better than a diary.
- **C.** To show readers how to make their own timeline, step by step.
- **D.** To share his own favorite memories of being a young child.

Q15 RI.2.3

How are the events on Tramayne's timeline connected to one another?

- **A.** They are sorted by color, not by time.
- **B.** They are put in time order — earlier events on the left and the most current on the right.
- **C.** They are mixed up at random.
- **D.** They are all rhyming poems.

Q16 RI.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "How to Make a Timeline"?

- **A.** A timeline must list every single event from a person's whole life, with nothing left out.
- **B.** Only a grown-up can decide which events are important enough to put on a timeline.
- **C.** The most current event always matters far more than any of the older events.
- **D.** Anyone can put events in order and make a timeline of their own life or learning.

Story 3 · The Stories He Tells: Joseph Bruchac

BIOGRAPHY · JAMES BRUCHAC · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.2.1

Who is Joseph Bruchac?

- **A.** A children's doctor.
- **B.** A Native American (Abenaki) storyteller.
- **C.** A cloud in the sky.
- **D.** A teacher who taught Helen Keller.

Q18 RI.2.3

When Joseph was young, how did he feel about his Native American heritage?

- **A.** He felt ashamed and tried to hide it.
- **B.** He was always loud and proud.
- **C.** He did not think about it at all.
- **D.** He moved to a new country to forget it.

Q19 RI.2.3

Who taught Joseph to love nature and animals?

- **A.** A school principal.
- **B.** A friend from school.
- **C.** A music teacher.
- **D.** His grandfather (Abenaki).

Q20 RI.2.3

From whom did Joseph learn the old stories of his people?

- **A.** The TV news.
- **B.** A storybook he found at the store.
- **C.** The elders of his community.
- **D.** His baby brother.

Q21 RI.2.3

How did Joseph's feelings about his heritage CHANGE?

- **A.** He went from feeling small to feeling rich.
- **B.** He went from feeling ashamed to feeling overflowing with pride.
- **C.** He stopped caring about stories.
- **D.** He decided to leave his family.

Q22 RI.2.8

The text says that when Joseph grew up, he became known all across the world as a Native American storyteller. This detail MOSTLY helps explain why —

- **A.** Joseph decided to leave his whole family behind.
- **B.** Grandpa Jesse first had to leave school very early.
- **C.** Joseph felt safe to share the stories his grandfather had hidden.
- **D.** Joseph stopped telling any stories to his two sons.

Q23 RI.2.6

Why MOST LIKELY did James Bruchac write a biography of his father, Joseph?

- **A.** To prove that his father is a better storyteller than the Abenaki elders.
- **B.** To tell his own life story as Joseph's son.
- **C.** To share Joseph's story and keep the Abenaki stories alive.
- **D.** To teach readers about the animals and nature near Saratoga Springs.

Q24 RI.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Stories He Tells"?

- **A.** A grandfather's love for nature matters far more than the old stories of his own people.
- **B.** Once a person feels ashamed of their heritage, that feeling can never really change again.
- **C.** Stories should be kept hidden inside the family and never shared with the outside world.
- **D.** Learning from elders can turn shame into pride — the stories you carry shape who you become.

Story 4 · Drum Dream Girl

POETRY · MARGARITA ENGLE · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.2.5

"Drum Dream Girl" is —

- **A.** A poem — based on the true story of a Cuban girl who dreamed of playing drums.
- **B.** A how-to guide for drummers.
- **C.** A long fantasy with dragons.
- **D.** A weather report.

Q26 RL.2.3

In Cuba, who was **allowed** to play the drums at first?

- **A.** Only grown-ups.
- **B.** Only teachers.
- **C.** Only boys.
- **D.** Only old women.

Q27 RL.2.3

How did the drum dream girl keep her dream alive at first?

- **A.** She gave up on it right away.
- **B.** She dreamed and drummed alone, in secret.
- **C.** She told everyone in school.
- **D.** She painted a picture of a drum and threw it away.

Q28 RL.2.4

"She heard the **whir** of parrot wings." This sound word helps the reader —

- **A.** count the parrots.
- **B.** see a parrot's color.
- **C.** taste a fruit.
- **D.** hear the soft, fast humming sound of wings — like a drumbeat.

Q29 RL.2.3

Who finally helped the drum dream girl find a teacher?

- **A.** Her father.
- **B.** A parrot.
- **C.** Her older sisters' band.
- **D.** A girl from school.

Q30 RL.2.3

What did the music teacher decide about the girl's drumming?

- **A.** It was too quiet.
- **B.** Her drumming deserved to be heard.
- **C.** She should stop drumming forever.
- **D.** Only boys could play.

Q31 RL.2.6

Whose point of view does "Drum Dream Girl" MOSTLY follow?

- **A.** The father's view, told only by him.
- **B.** The older sisters' view of their dance band.
- **C.** The music teacher's view from the stage.
- **D.** The drum dream girl's view — her secret dreaming, her drumming alone, and her wish to be heard.

Q32 RL.2.2

What is the BIG IDEA of "Drum Dream Girl"?

- **A.** A dream stays alive only if you tell everyone about it right away.
- **B.** The older sisters' dance band is what finally changes the rule about drums.
- **C.** Daring to dream, practicing in secret, and one helper can change an unfair rule.
- **D.** A girl's drumming counts only after a teacher says it deserves to be heard.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 7 · Everyone Has a Story · Grade 2

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each story to think more deeply about who you are. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Perspective DOK 3

In **"I Am Helen Keller,"** the story is told in Helen's OWN voice. Show what the world FELT like through Helen's senses before and after Miss Sullivan came.

HELEN'S WORLD · BEFORE & AFTER

BEFORE · NO WORDS YET	→	AFTER · WORDS IN HER HAND

What does seeing through Helen's eyes (and hands) teach us about people who learn differently?

Q2 Form DOK 2

In **"How to Make a Timeline,"** events go in order on a line. Make a SHORT timeline of YOUR life — three events you remember.

MY THREE-EVENT TIMELINE

EARLIEST · WHEN I WAS LITTLE	IN THE MIDDLE	MOST CURRENT · THIS YEAR

Which event shaped YOU the most? Why?

Q3 Change DOK 3

In **"The Stories He Tells,"** Joseph Bruchac changes from feeling ASHAMED of his heritage to feeling OVERFLOWING with pride. Map his change — and the people who helped him.

FROM SHAME TO PRIDE · JOSEPH'S WEB

Joseph Bruchac

HELPER 1 · GRANDFATHER

HELPER 2 · GRANDMOTHER

HELPER 3 · ELDERS

HELPER 4 · HIS OWN SON

What ONE moment turned shame into pride? Why?

Q4 Causation DOK 3

In **"Drum Dream Girl,"** a quiet rule said only boys could play drums. The girl CHANGED that rule. Trace what she DID — see, hear, feel — at three moments.

THREE MOMENTS · DRUM DREAM GIRL

STEP 1 · SECRET

what does she do alone?

STEP 2 · DARED

what does she ask for?

STEP 3 · HEARD

what changes at the starlit café?

What ONE small action CAUSED the big change?

Q5 Reflection DOK 4

Essential Question: How do our experiences shape our lives? Use ideas from TWO of the texts you read in this module.

TWO-TEXT SYNTHESIS

TEXT 1 · TITLE & AUTHOR

Which experience changed this person — and how did it shape who they became?

TEXT 2 · TITLE & AUTHOR

Which experience changed this person — and how did it shape who they became?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 7 · Everyone Has a Story · Grade 2

MAP RIT 180 → 200 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the stories in this workbook.

Passage 1 · Lina's First Letter

Lina was six. She had just moved with her family from Korea to a new city. She did not know any English. At school, she sat quietly. The other kids talked fast. Lina did not understand. One day, her teacher gave each child a card. "Write a letter to someone," the teacher said. Lina did not know what to write. She drew a picture of her grandmother in Busan. She wrote the only English word she knew, BIG, beside her grandmother's smile. The teacher hugged her. The teacher pinned the picture on the wall. Soon other kids came to look. "Who is this?" they asked. Lina pointed at the smile. "Halmoni," she said. The kids learned a new word. Lina learned that even one word, drawn with care, can be a story.

130 WORDS · LEXILE 240–290L · RIT 180–189

Q1 RIT 180 | Lexile 240L | Key Detail

Where did Lina just move from?

- ○ **A.** Japan.
- ○ **B.** The countryside.
- ○ **C.** Another school in the same city.
- ○ **D.** Korea.

Q2 RIT 184 | Lexile 250L | Cause & Effect

Why did Lina sit quietly at school?

- ○ **A.** She did not know any English yet.
- ○ **B.** She was sleepy.
- ○ **C.** She did not like the teacher.
- ○ **D.** She was angry.

Q3 RIT 186 Lexile 260L Inference

Why did Lina draw a picture instead of writing words?

- A. She forgot her pencil at home.
- B. She did not have enough English words yet — so a picture told her story.
- C. She did not want to do the lesson.
- D. The teacher told her to draw, not write.

Q4 RIT 188 Lexile 270L Vocabulary

In the passage, "Halmoni" is —

- A. A kind of food.
- B. The Korean word for grandmother.
- C. The name of the city.
- D. The name of Lina's dog.

Q5 RIT 189 Lexile 290L Main Idea / Moral

How does this experience shape Lina?

- A. It teaches her that she must learn every English word before she can share anything.
- B. It shows her that a picture is not a real way to tell a story to others.
- C. It shows her that the other kids will only be her friends if she speaks first.
- D. It teaches her that even one careful word — with a picture — can tell her story and make new friends.

Passage 2 · The Last Note

Min-su's grandfather kept a small wooden box on his shelf. Inside the box were notes. They were written on yellow paper. Some were as old as fifty years. "These are letters from my mother," Grandfather said. "She wrote me one note every year on my birthday until she died. I keep them all." Min-su asked, "Why do you keep paper?" "Because the paper carries her voice," Grandfather said. "I read one note each year, on the day she wrote it. That way, I still hear her every year." Min-su touched the most current note. It was the newest one Grandfather had written — a note he was writing to Min-su, for the year Min-su would turn ten. "When I am gone," Grandfather said, "this box is yours."

135 WORDS · LEXILE 300–350L · RIT 190–195

Q6 RIT 190 Lexile 300L Key Detail

What did Grandfather keep in the small wooden box?

- A. Old coins.
- B. Photographs.
- C. Notes on yellow paper from his mother.
- D. Toy cars.

Q7 RIT 192 Lexile 320L Cause & Effect

Why did Grandfather read one note each year?

- A. Because his mother told him to read fast.
- B. So he could still hear his mother's voice once a year, on the same date she wrote it.
- C. Because he could not read more than one.
- D. Because Min-su asked him to.

Q8 RIT 193 Lexile 330L Vocabulary

In the passage, "the most CURRENT note" most likely means —

- A. the loudest note.
- B. the newest note — the one written most lately.
- C. the oldest note of all.
- D. a note made of paper money.

Q9 RIT 194 Lexile 340L Inference

Why does Grandfather plan to give Min-su the box?

- A. Because he wants Min-su to throw it away.
- B. So Min-su can sell the paper for money.
- C. So Min-su can hear Grandfather's voice across the years — the way Grandfather hears his mother's.
- D. Because the box is broken.

Q10 RIT 195 Lexile 350L Main Idea / Moral

How do family experiences shape Min-su in this passage?

- A. Min-su learns that a small box of writing can carry love and a voice through many years.
- B. Min-su learns that the best way to honor family is to forget the sad parts of the past.
- C. Min-su decides that talking out loud is always better than keeping old written notes.
- D. Min-su decides that the paper itself matters more than the words written on it.

Passage 3 · The Boy Who Drew Bridges

Diego loved drawing bridges. He drew them on napkins. He drew them in the dirt. He drew them on the back of every homework page. His older brother said, "Stop drawing. Do real work." But Diego could not stop. He liked how a bridge connects one side to another side. When Diego was eight, his family moved to a new town. His new school made him sit next to a boy named Jin. Jin was new too — from Korea. The two boys could not talk much, but Diego drew a bridge on his notebook. He drew a small Diego on one side and a small Jin on the other. He pushed the paper to Jin. Jin smiled. He pointed at the bridge and said, "Friend." That night, Diego knew. He was going to be an engineer. He would build real bridges for people like him and Jin.

148 WORDS · LEXILE 360–410L · RIT 195–199

Q11 RIT 195 Lexile 360L Key Detail

What did Diego love to draw?

- A. Boats.
- B. Cars.
- C. Birds.
- D. Bridges.

Q12 RIT 196 Lexile 370L Cause & Effect

What happened RIGHT AFTER Diego pushed the bridge drawing to Jin?

- A. Jin tore it up.
- B. Jin smiled and said one word — "Friend."
- C. The teacher took the paper away.
- D. Diego's brother saw it.

Q13 RIT 197 Lexile 380L Inference

Why did Diego draw a bridge between a "small Diego" and a "small Jin"?

- A. He needed to fill the page.
- B. He wanted to show that two people from different places could meet — a bridge connects sides.
- C. He wanted Jin to copy it.
- D. The teacher told him to.

Q14 RIT 198 | Lexile 390L | Vocabulary

Diego's brother told him to "do real work." In the passage, this most likely meant —

- ○ **A.** Drawing is not real or useful — Diego should do schoolwork only.
- ○ **B.** Diego should sleep more.
- ○ **C.** Diego should draw bigger bridges.
- ○ **D.** Diego should buy new pencils.

Q15 RIT 199 | Lexile 410L | Main Idea / Moral

How does this experience SHAPE Diego's future?

- ○ **A.** He decides to become an engineer who builds real bridges — because the drawing showed him what bridges could do for real people.
- ○ **B.** He decides to listen to his brother and stop drawing so he can do only real schoolwork.
- ○ **C.** He decides that drawing is just a game and can never lead to a real job one day.
- ○ **D.** He decides that the only thing that matters is winning his new friend Jin back.

Passage 4 · The Runner Who Could Not Speak

Amara was eight when she came to her new country. She could not yet speak the language. At first, she sat in the back of the classroom and watched. Some days, she felt smaller than the smallest bird. One afternoon, the teacher said, "Today is fun-run day." The whole class went outside. Amara understood the word RUN — and her body knew what to do. The teacher said, "Ready! Set! Go!" Amara ran. She ran past the boy who told her she was slow. She ran past the girl who had laughed at her name. She ran all the way to the end of the field. She came in first. When she crossed the line, the class cheered for her — even the children who could not say her name yet. Amara had no English. But she had something she could DO. From that day, she stopped feeling small. She knew her story was just beginning.

150 WORDS · LEXILE 440–500L · RIT 199–200

Q16 RIT 199 | Lexile 440L | Key Detail

How old was Amara when she came to her new country?

- ○ **A.** Three.
- ○ **B.** Twelve.
- ○ **C.** Fifteen.
- ○ **D.** Eight.

Q17 RIT 200 | Lexile 460L | Cause & Effect

Why did Amara sit at the back of the classroom at first?

- **A.** She did not yet speak the language — she watched and listened.
- **B.** Her shoes hurt.
- **C.** The teacher told her to.
- **D.** She did not like school chairs.

Q18 RIT 200 | Lexile 480L | Vocabulary

"Amara had no English. But she had something she could DO." This most likely means —

- **A.** Words are the only way to belong.
- **B.** Running was just for fun.
- **C.** A person can show who they are through action — not only through words.
- **D.** Amara wanted to become a teacher.

Q19 RIT 200 | Lexile 490L | Inference

Why did the children CHEER for Amara at the end?

- **A.** Because she finished last.
- **B.** Because she had said something funny.
- **C.** Because she had won the race — and they saw her, even without her words.
- **D.** Because the teacher told them to.

Q20 RIT 200 | Lexile 500L | Main Idea / Moral

How does this experience SHAPE Amara?

- **A.** She decides that winning races is the only way she will ever matter to her class.
- **B.** She decides she does not need to learn the language now that she can run fast.
- **C.** She stops feeling small — she sees that what she can DO is also a story, and her story is just beginning.
- **D.** She decides the other children will never really understand her without her own words.